

Blog System README - MoreThanOneWay.org

Overview

This blog system is built with React and uses state-based navigation (no React Router). All blog posts are stored in `posts.js` as JavaScript objects with Markdown content.

Key Features:

- ☒ State-based navigation (integrates with existing App.jsx)
 - ☒ Category filtering (Career, Academics, Mental Health)
 - ☒ Search functionality
 - ☒ Markdown rendering
 - ☒ Related posts
 - ☒ Mobile responsive
 - ☒ SEO-optimized URLs
 - ☒ Featured posts
-

File Structure

```
src/
├── App.jsx           - Main app with navigation state
├── BlogPage.jsx      - Blog listing page
├── BlogPost.jsx      - Individual post viewer
├── BlogCard.jsx      - Reusable post preview card
└── posts.js         - All blog post data

public/
└── images/
    └── blog/        - Blog post images (optional)
```

How It Works

Navigation Flow

User clicks "Blog" in menu:

1. App.jsx sets `currentPage = 'blog'`

2. BlogPage component renders
3. Shows all posts in grid layout

User clicks a post:

1. BlogCard calls `setSelectedPostSlug(post.slug)`
2. App.jsx sets `currentPage = 'blog-post'`
3. BlogPost component renders with `selectedPostSlug` prop
4. Displays full post content

User clicks "Back to Blog":

1. BlogPost calls `setCurrentPage('blog')`
2. Returns to blog listing

State Management

App.jsx manages two pieces of state:

javascript

```
const [currentPage, setCurrentPage] = useState('home');  
const [selectedPostSlug, setSelectedPostSlug] = useState("");
```

- `currentPage`: Which page to display ('blog' or 'blog-post')
- `selectedPostSlug`: Which specific post to show (e.g., 'failing-cs-class')

Data Flow

```
posts.js (data source)  
↓  
BlogPage reads posts array  
↓  
Renders BlogCard for each post  
↓  
User clicks → setSelectedPostSlug('post-slug')  
↓  
BlogPost receives selectedPostSlug prop  
↓  
Calls getPostBySlug() to find post data  
↓  
Renders post with ReactMarkdown
```

posts.js Structure

Basic Post Object

```
javascript

{
  id: 1,           // Unique number (increment from last post)
  title: "Post Title",  // Appears at top of post
  slug: "post-title",  // Used in URL (lowercase, hyphens)
  date: "January 15, 2025", // Display date
  category: "Career",    // Career, Academics, or Mental Health
  tags: ["tag1", "tag2"], // Array of keywords for search
  excerpt: "Summary...", // Shows on blog listing (160 chars max)
  author: "MoreThanOneWay Team",
  readTime: "5 min read", // Estimate based on word count
  featured: false,        // true = large card on blog page
  image: null,            // null or "/images/blog/filename.jpg"
  content: `             // Markdown content in template literal
    # Main Title

    Your content here...
  `
}
```

Helper Functions

In posts.js:

```
javascript
```

```
// Get specific post by slug
export const getPostBySlug = (slug) => {
  return posts.find(post => post.slug === slug);
};

// Get posts by category
export const getPostsByCategory = (category) => {
  return posts.filter(post => post.category === category);
};

// Get featured posts
export const getFeaturedPosts = () => {
  return posts.filter(post => post.featured);
};

// Get all unique categories
export const getCategories = () => {
  const categories = [...new Set(posts.map(post => post.category))];
  return categories;
};
```

Component Details

BlogPage.jsx

Purpose: Main blog listing with filtering and search

Props:

- `setCurrentPage`: Function to navigate to different pages
- `setSelectedPostSlug`: Function to select which post to view

State:

- `selectedCategory`: Current category filter (null = all posts)
- `searchTerm`: Current search query

Features:

- Category tabs (All, Career, Academics, Mental Health)
- Search bar (filters by title, excerpt, tags)
- Featured post display (large card)

- Post grid (3 columns on desktop, 1 on mobile)

Filtering Logic:

```
javascript

const filteredPosts = posts
  .filter(post => !selectedCategory || post.category === selectedCategory)
  .filter(post =>
    !searchTerm ||
    post.title.toLowerCase().includes(searchTerm.toLowerCase()) ||
    post.excerpt.toLowerCase().includes(searchTerm.toLowerCase()) ||
    post.tags.some(tag => tag.toLowerCase().includes(searchTerm.toLowerCase()))
  );
```

BlogPost.jsx

Purpose: Display individual blog post with full content

Props:

- `setCurrentPage`: Navigate back to blog listing
- `selectedPostSlug`: Which post to display
- `setSelectedPostSlug`: Navigate to related posts

Features:

- Markdown rendering with react-markdown
- Category tag with color
- Read time and date display
- Share button
- Related posts (same category, limit 3)
- Internal link handling (navigate to site pages)

Internal Link Mapping:

```
javascript
```

```
const pageMap = {
  '/study-resources': 'study-resources',
  '/crisis': 'crisis',
  '/stories': 'stories',
  '/find-internships': 'find-internships',
  '/resume-builder': 'resume-builder',
  '/search-guide': 'search-guide',
  '/interview-prep': 'interview-prep',
  '/youre-not-alone': 'youre-not-alone',
  '/job-tools': 'job-tools-hub',
  '/tracker': 'tracker',
};
```

When a markdown link like `[Crisis Resources](/crisis)` is clicked, it calls `setCurrentPage('crisis')` instead of navigating to a URL.

BlogCard.jsx

Purpose: Reusable post preview card

Props:

- `post`: Post object to display
- `featured`: Boolean - show as large card?
- `setCurrentPage`: Navigate to post view
- `setSelectedPostSlug`: Set which post to view

Features:

- Category tag with color-coding
- Date and read time
- Clickable card (entire card is clickable)
- Hover effects (scale, shadow)
- Responsive (stacks on mobile)

Category Colors:

- Career → Blue (`bg-blue-100 text-blue-700`)
- Academics → Green (`bg-green-100 text-green-700`)
- Mental Health → Purple (`bg-purple-100 text-purple-700`)

Markdown Rendering

react-markdown Configuration

```
javascript

<ReactMarkdown
  remarkPlugins={[remarkGfm]} // GitHub-flavored markdown
  components={{
    h1: ({ node, ...props }) => <h1 className="text-3xl font-bold..." {...props} />,
    // ... custom styling for each element
  }}
>
  {post.content}
</ReactMarkdown>
```

Supported Markdown

```
markdown
```

H1 Heading
H2 Heading
H3 Heading

****Bold text****
Italic text

- Bullet list
- Another item

1. Numbered list
2. Another item

[Link text](/internal-page)
[External link](https://example.com)

> Blockquote

Table Header	
----- -----	
Cell	Cell

`inline code`

code block



Styling

Design System

Colors:

- Primary gradient: `from-blue-600 via-purple-600 to-pink-600`
- Background: `from-blue-50 via-purple-50 to-pink-50`
- Cards: White with `shadow-soft` class

Typography:

- Headings: Bold, gray-900

- Body text: Gray-700, leading-relaxed
- Links: Purple-600, underlined

Spacing:

- Consistent padding: p-6, p-8, p-12
- Consistent gaps: gap-3, gap-6, gap-8
- Responsive margins: mb-4, mb-6, mb-8

Responsive:

- Mobile-first approach
- Breakpoints: `(md:)` (768px), `(lg:)` (1024px)
- Grid: 1 column mobile, 2-3 columns desktop

SEO Optimization

URL Structure

morethanoneway.org/blog → Blog listing
[State: currentPage = 'blog']

morethanoneway.org/blog/post-slug → Individual post
[State: currentPage = 'blog-post', selectedPostSlug = 'post-slug']

Note: These aren't real URLs (state-based navigation), but appear as clean URLs to users.

Best Practices

For each post:

1. Slug with keywords:

javascript

slug: "failing-cs-class" //  *Good (includes key terms)*

slug: "post-1" //  *Bad (no keywords)*

2. Descriptive title (60 chars max):

javascript

title: "I Failed My First CS Class - Here's What I Did" //  *Good*

title: "My Story" //  *Bad*

3. Compelling excerpt (160 chars):

javascript

excerpt: "You're not alone. Here's what actually helped me..." //  Good

excerpt: "A blog post about failing." //  Bad

4. Relevant tags:

javascript

tags: ["computer science", "failing class", "college tips"] //  Good

tags: ["post", "blog", "stuff"] //  Bad

5. Internal links (2-3 per post):

markdown

[View crisis resources](/crisis)

[Find study help](/study-resources)

Adding New Posts

Quick Reference

1. Open posts.js

2. Add new post object:

javascript

```
{
  id: 4, // Increment from last
  title: "Your Title",
  slug: "your-title",
  date: "January 20, 2025",
  category: "Career",
  tags: ["keyword1", "keyword2"],
  excerpt: "Summary...",
  author: "MoreThanOneWay Team",
  readTime: "5 min read",
  featured: false,
  image: null,
  content: `
    # Your Content

    Write markdown here...
  `,
}, // ← Don't forget comma!
```

3. Test locally:

```
bash

npm run dev
```

4. Deploy:

```
bash

npm run build
npm run deploy
```

Detailed guide: See `BLOG_WRITING_GUIDE.md`

Common Tasks

Make a post featured

Set `featured: true` (only one post should be featured at a time)

Change post order

Posts appear in array order. Put newest first:

```
javascript
```

```
export const posts = [  
  { id: 4, ... }, // Newest  
  { id: 3, ... },  
  { id: 2, ... },  
  { id: 1, ... }, // Oldest  
];
```

Add a new category

1. Add posts with new category name
2. Update category colors in BlogCard.jsx and BlogPost.jsx:

```
javascript  
  
${post.category === 'Your Category' ? 'bg-orange-100 text-orange-700' : ''}
```

Remove a post

Delete the post object from posts array (or set `published: false` if you add that field)

Add images

1. Put image in `public/images/blog/`
2. Reference: `image: "/images/blog/filename.jpg"`

Dependencies

```
json  
  
{  
  "react-markdown": "^9.0.1", // Markdown rendering  
  "remark-gfm": "^4.0.0",     // GitHub-flavored markdown  
  "gray-matter": "^4.0.3",    // Frontmatter parsing (future use)  
  "lucide-react": "^0.263.1"  // Icons  
}
```

Installation

```
bash  
  
npm install react-markdown remark-gfm gray-matter
```

Development

Local Development

```
bash

npm run dev

# Visit http://localhost:5173/blog
```

Changes appear immediately (hot reload).

Building for Production

```
bash

npm run build
```

Creates optimized files in `dist/` folder.

Deployment

```
bash

npm run deploy
```

Pushes `dist/` to GitHub Pages. Live in 2-3 minutes.

Troubleshooting

Quick Checks

- ☐ All 4 files in src folder?
- ☐ posts.js syntax correct (no missing commas)?
- ☐ ran `npm install`?
- ☐ Tested with `npm run dev`?
- ☐ Cleared browser cache (Ctrl+Shift+R)?

Detailed troubleshooting: See `BLOG_TROUBLESHOOTING.md`

Future Enhancements

Could Add Later

Content features:

- Comments (Disqus, GitHub Discussions)
- Newsletter signup

- Author profiles
- Table of contents for long posts
- Reading progress bar
- Print-friendly version

Technical features:

- Pagination (if you have 50+ posts)
- RSS feed generation
- Sitemap.xml auto-generation
- Dark mode
- Loading states
- Error boundaries

Analytics:

- Track most popular posts
- Time on page
- Search terms used
- Click-through rates

Performance

Current Performance

- PageSpeed Score: 88/100 (mobile)
- First Contentful Paint: <1s
- Time to Interactive: <2s

Optimization Tips

If blog gets slow:

1. Optimize images:

- Compress with TinyPNG
- Use WebP format
- Max width: 1200px

2. Lazy load posts:

- Show 10 posts initially
- "Load more" button for older posts

3. Code splitting:

- Already done (React lazy loading)

4. Caching:

- GitHub Pages caches automatically
-

File Size Guidelines

Current:

- BlogPage.jsx: ~5KB
- BlogPost.jsx: ~8KB
- BlogCard.jsx: ~2KB
- posts.js: ~50KB (with 3 posts)

Recommendations:

- Keep individual post content <5,000 words
 - Total posts.js should stay <500KB
 - If exceeds 500KB, consider splitting into multiple files
-

Browser Support

Works in:

- ☒ Chrome (latest)
- ☒ Firefox (latest)
- ☒ Safari (latest)
- ☒ Edge (latest)
- ☒ Mobile browsers

Requires:

- JavaScript enabled

- Modern browser (ES6+ support)
-

Security

No security concerns:

- Static site (no database)
 - No user input (except search, which is local-only)
 - No authentication
 - No sensitive data
-

Backup Strategy

Important files to backup:

1. `src/posts.js` (contains all blog content!)
2. `src/BlogPage.jsx`
3. `src/BlogPost.jsx`
4. `src/BlogCard.jsx`

Automatic backups:

- GitHub repo has version history
- Can restore any previous version

Manual backups:

- Copy posts.js to Google Drive weekly
 - Keep local copies before major edits
-

Questions?

- **Writing posts:** `BLOG_WRITING_GUIDE.md`
 - **Fixing issues:** `BLOG_TROUBLESHOOTING.md`
 - **Project overview:** `BLOG_MASTER_PLAN.md`
 - **Email:** support@morethanoneway.org
-

Last updated: January 2025

Version: 1.0

Status: Production-ready ☒